

Conklin Food Co-op Now Forming

The 70's will soon be history! We will remember them as years which taught us to conserve our energy and our financial resources. One thing we all have in common is trying to find new ways to save money. Families in the Conklin area are now in the process of doing just that. They are forming their own food co-op which will operate in the location now known as Collison's Food Store. The Conklin Food Co-op is tentatively scheduled to begin operation on March 1, 1977.

The store will be rented from Glen and Sara Collison who opened the present grocery store in February of 1972.

The Co-op will be controlled by a board of directors, elected by the shareholders; each shareholder will have only one vote regardless of the number of shares owned.

While the Co-op will be open to all, members will realize a special benefit on each purchase - a cash discount allowed at the checkout on the total of their

cash register tape. This will be a complete grocery Co-op with fresh produce, complete dairy products, a quality fresh meat department, including a complete line of bulk cheese, luncheon meat, bacon and other related items. The Co-op will be connected with a large wholesale Co-op for the grocery items. There will be an area of natural foods such as grains, flours, dry milk, peanut butter, nuts, dried beans and dried fruits. It will be possible to buy these items in bulk quantities if so desired which will mean even greater savings.

Through this Co-op the members will save money as shopping here will cost less than the larger chain stores, but they will also save time, gas and other automobile expenses. Following the pattern of community involvement that is a mark of the present store, the Co-op will continue to serve as a center of information and activity for area residents. With a central location announcing blood drives, church suppers, benefits, etc., all members can feel they are sharing in development of the community and maintaining the small town lifestyle they are presently enjoying.

Anyone (this opportunity is not limited only to residents of Conklin) wishing to have more information may call Glen Collison at 899-2147 or Tim Violet at 899-5544.



The state's 35,000 snowmobilers have certainly been a pleasant lot this year. Their smiling faces will readily tell you they have been enjoying an especially snowy Michigan winter. And with more and more trails being opened up each year for their powdery pleasure, I'm sure these ear-to-ear grins will be around for some time yet.

Recently opened up to West Michigan powersled fans were the State Game Areas at Allegan, Barry, Flat River, Stanton and Rogue River. Rules stipulate that at least four inches of snow must be on the ground, and also that snowmobilers should stick to designated trails.

Farther north, the DNR continued to open up new state forest lands and other public trails, making for a total of nearly 3,000 miles of trails now posted with the familiar orange diamond markers.

While no new major construction was done this past year, a number of short connecting routes were completed according to Forest Recreation Supervisor Mike Moore.

"Snowmobilers are welcome to use our nearly four million acres of state forest lands, except where a very few areas are marked 'closed'," says Moore. "We estimate that about 10,000 miles of unplowed state forest and country roads are used by the snowmobilers, too."

Persons interested in using these trails will find individual maps of each developed state forest snowmobile trail available at local DNR field offices. The DNR says some of the most popular trails have been the Fur Farm Flooding Trail at Harrison, Blue Bear Trail east of Kalkaska and the Dollarville Dam Trail at Newberry.

Designated portions of most state parks and recreation areas are also available for snowmobiling as long as there is four inches of snow to cushion powersleds. Park permits are required for both snowmobiles and transporting vehicles entering those lands.

Snowmobiles must be registered in Michigan through the offices of the Secretary of State. In addition, young snowmobilers ages 12-to-16, who operate the snow machines without adult supervision, must have snowmobile safety certificates. DNR field offices also have necessary information about the safety courses required for certification.

Snowmobilers are reminded that those trails which are marked in blue are reserved strictly for winter hikers and cross-country skiers.

ICE FISHING UPDATE
Panfishing continues to be a good bet throughout the region. Some of the better bets to date have been Peck and Tupper lakes in Ionia County; Camp, Wabasis and

Cranberry lakes in Kent County; Big Whitefish, Crystal and Tamarack lakes in Montcalm County; Wolf, Bear and White lakes in Muskegon County; Stearns, Brucers and Pottowattomie bayous in Ottawa County; the Swan Creek refuge, Green Lake and Lake Sixteen in Allegan County and Thornapple, Crooked, Pine and Gun lakes in Barry County.

Pike fishing has also been good in the area. Tip-up fishermen are scoring on both frozen smelt and live chubs.

NOTE: ON AGAIN, OFF AGAIN is the way the Beaver Basin deer hunt can be described. Just after it seemed the DNR had won its sparring and jousting match with the state legislature and U.P. residents, (and after I had penned a rather lengthy column on how the Beaver Basin hunt was still on) a surprise court injunction halted the hunt. Alger County residents took their case to court and have won another battle. But the war isn't over yet as neither side appears to be willing to back down.

The status at this writing is still in limbo. We'll try to keep you posted on this fast moving confrontation. The DNR's policy making ability seems to be on the line and any final decisions will certainly have far reaching impact.

Notice

Red Pine Bible Church will host Jordan West Bible College Musical group, Sun. Morning Jan. 30 at 11:00. Everyone welcome.

Evening T.O.P.S. No.373

The New Year is now under way. Have you taken a good look at what the past year has done for you? Are you slimmer, fatter, standing still, or are you still marching onward with TOPS, by growing slimmer each week? As we march along together encouraging each other in our down in the valley weeks and in our slimmer up on the mountain tops the next.

Soon election time will be here. Have you given thought who will be best in the officers seat? Concerned and willing workers to work overtime to help you personally and as a group in TOPS. Taking Off Pounds Sensibly can be a challenge, pound by pound, person to person and group to group. Past members and discouraged members that want to quit. Look ahead rejoin TOPS, Start attending meetings faithfully, have say in your By Laws and get behind yourself and your Club Officers, work together for a good 1977. Let's not let fat defeat us, let us defeat the fat. See you at TOPS at the Sparta Civic Center, on Tuesday night. Right On! We start at 7:15 p.m.

Just a reminder that our Bake Sale will be held from 2:00 to 6:00 p.m. at the Sparta State Bank on the 28th of January.

Notice

Bible Studys are being held at Riverview Roll-a-Home, Lot 77, Viking Dr. Full gospel teaching. Everyone welcome. Every Sat. Night at 7:30 p.m.

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